

fectly, and any attempt to pull them apart has the presumption strongly against it. Two documents were united, beyond doubt, somewhere in this vicinity, but it was not at *this* point. And again, the evidence of translation from a Semitic original is quite as noticeable in the latter part of chap. 4 as it is in 5: 1-6. Observe, for example, the idiom in vs. 63: *καὶ τὸ ἱερὸν οὐ ὠνομάσθη τὸ ὄνομα αὐτοῦ ἐπ' αὐτῷ*; and similarly in vs. 54: *ἐν τίνι λατρεύουσιν ἐν αὐτῇ*. Now although these verses do not belong to the unexpanded Story of the Three Youths (which, as will be shown presently, ends at 4: 42), they belong to the context in which it was imbedded. Moreover, in some of the verses which now form a part of the Story, and can only have been written in continuation of it, the marks which indicate the work of a translator are plainly to be seen. The verses 4: 44-46, 57, for example, in the sustained awkwardness with which they render Semitic idioms—and probably reproduce Semitic blunders—could easily be paralleled in other specimens of “translation Greek,” but hardly in Greek of any other type.

The antecedent probability, from every side, of a Semitic original for the Episode is thus overwhelming, and we may fairly take for granted, at the outset, the fact of translation (substituting “ohne Zweifel semitisch” for “ohne Zweifel griechisch”). Only very strong evidence in the Greek text of 3: 1-4: 42, such evidence, namely, as to show that it could not have been the work of a translator, could suffice to shake this probability; and such evidence, as has already been said, is not to be had.

It only remains to determine whether the original language was Hebrew or Aramaic. This question, usually a very difficult one, is here rendered easy of answer by the use of the Greek word *τότε*, in 3: 4, 8; 4: 33, 41, 42, 43, 47, which points plainly to an Aramaic original. The only places in the Greek Old Testament in which *τότε*, “then,” “thereupon,” is consistently used to continue a narrative are the Aramaic portions of Daniel and Ezra and this Story of the Three Youths. The usage is neither Greek nor Hebrew; the word can stand only for the Aramaic *אָדָּן* (or *בְּאִדָּן*). It is not a question of one or two occurrences, such as can be found here and there in all Greek literature; the word appears again and again, all through the narrative, in every one of these sections in which the Greek is translated from Aramaic, but does not appear similarly anywhere else. In this Story there